MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS ENGLISH

PRACTICE COMPANION BOOKLET • ZERO MODEL ANSWERS

LEVEL 1



PRACTICE COMPANION

22 independent exam tasks for complete mock assessment

22 Tasks | Zero Models | Exam Layout | Mark Rubrics

ENGLISH WRITING LEVEL 1 COMPANION

Functional Skills English • Writing

Level 1 • Independent Exam Practice & Pure Mock Assessment

This book belongs to:	Exam date:	Target level:

What is inside

1–22	22 Independent Exam Tasks Across All 11 Formats (44 pages)	4
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How to use this book

Read
Read the rule. Study the picture.

Try
Write your answers on the lines.

Check
Mark it with the answers at the back.

Remember
Learn the Golden Rule by heart.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK • INDEPENDENT STUDY

GUIDE

Level 1 Companion Workbook • Independent Practice Guide

Practice Instructions

This workbook contains **22 unseen practice tasks** (two tasks for each of the 11 functional formats), four complete mock examinations, and eight diagnostic drills. Use this book to build speed, accuracy, and confidence.

- Time yourself: 35 minutes for 21-mark tasks; 25 minutes for 15-mark tasks.
- Cover all bullet points and check punctuation carefully.

Word Bank

Use the word bank provided in each task.

Punctuation

Check every sentence ends with a full stop.

My Practice Plan

T1

EXAM TASK • 21 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Format 1: Article • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: Starting a New Hobby or Evening Class in Your Local Town Audience & Tone: Local community residents and adult learners (Friendly, positive, and inspiring). Specialist words: community, beginner, enroll, workshop, skills, confidence, socialise • Local community residents and adult learners (Friendly, positive, and inspiring). Specialist words: community, beginner, enroll, workshop, skills, confidence, socialise

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Share Your Story: Learning Something New in Our Town!
We want articles for our quarterly community centre magazine about why trying new activities is great for
mental wellbeing, making friends, and learning skills. Have you taken up a new hobby, joined a craft club, or
enrolled in an evening class (such as cooking, digital photography, gardening, pottery, or language)? Inspire
your neighbours to get involved!

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- describe a new hobby, activity, or class you recommend and what people do in it
- explain two personal benefits of learning a new skill (e.g. mental health, confidence, or socialising)
- give practical advice on how a beginner can sign up, find information, and get started.

Strategy: Read all bullet points carefully. Use an eye-catching title, a byline, and clear paragraphs for each point.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Words:** community, beginner, enroll, workshop, skills

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 21 MARKS

Format 1: Article • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Article response below (150 and 250 words):

T2

EXAM TASK • 21 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Format 1: Article • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: Protecting Local Wildlife & Creating Nature-Friendly Spaces Audience & Tone: Town residents, families, and school students (Enthusiastic and community-minded). Specialist words: environment, wildlife, habitat, hedgehog, birdfeeders, pesticide, volunteer • Town residents, families, and school students (Enthusiastic and community-minded). Specialist words: environment, wildlife, habitat, hedgehog, birdfeeders, pesticide, volunteer

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
HELP OUR TOWN GO GREEN: Support Local Nature!
Our local wild birds, hedgehogs, and pollinators need our help! The Green Spaces Action Group invites residents
to write an article for the local environmental newsletter explaining practical steps families and neighbours can
take in gardens, balconies, or shared green spaces to support wildlife.

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- explain why looking after wildlife in our neighbourhoods is important for the community
- explain how neighbours could work together to clean or improve a shared green space.

Strategy: Organise your article with subheadings or clear paragraphs. Use connecting words like *firstly, also, however,* and *finally*.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Words:** environment, wildlife, habitat, hedgehog, birdfeeders

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 21 MARKS

Format 1: Article • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Article response below (150 and 250 words):

T1

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 160 WORDS

Format 2: Email (Workplace) • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Requesting a College Field Trip / Exhibition Visit Audience & Tone: Your college course tutor, Mr David Harrison (Polite, professional, and persuasive). Specialist words: exhibition, transport, timetable, benefit, practical, permission, curriculum • Your college course tutor, Mr David Harrison (Polite, professional, and persuasive). Specialist words: exhibition, transport, timetable, benefit, practical, permission, curriculum

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Course Intranet Notice — Field Trips & Industry Visits
"If you have an idea for an educational visit, industry exhibition, or museum trip that would help our group with
our current course unit, please email me with your suggestion, dates, and why it would help us learn."
— David
Harrison, Course Tutor

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- state why you are writing and suggest the place you want the class to visit
- explain how this visit will help students with their coursework or practical skills

Strategy: Include a clear Subject line and use a polite greeting (Dear Mr Harrison) and formal sign-off (Kind regards).

Target: 100 and 160 words • **Words:** exhibition, transport, timetable, benefit, practical

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 15 MARKS

Format 2: Email (Workplace) • Candidate Response

✎ **Write your Email (Workplace) response below (100 and 160 words):**

T2

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 160 WORDS

Format 2: Email (Workplace) • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Workplace Energy Saving & Recycling Scheme Audience & Tone: Retail Store Manager, Ms Karen Patel (Helpful, polite, and constructive). Specialist words: recycling, electricity, packaging, environment, reduce, staff, suggestion • Retail Store Manager, Ms Karen Patel (Helpful, polite, and constructive). Specialist words: recycling, electricity, packaging, environment, reduce, staff, suggestion

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Staff Noticeboard Memo — Cutting Waste and Energy
"Dear Team, our supermarket wants to cut waste and reduce our energy bills. Please email me with your ideas
on how staff can help save electricity and recycle more packaging in the store and staffroom." — Karen Patel,
Store Manager

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- state why you are writing and give two ways staff can save energy (e.g. lighting, heating)

Strategy: Keep your email concise and structured. Use short paragraphs or bullet points to make suggestions clear.

Target: 100 and 160 words • **Words:** recycling, electricity, packaging, environment, reduce

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 15 MARKS

Format 2: Email (Workplace) • Candidate Response

✎ **Write your Email (Workplace) response below (100 and 160 words):**

EXAM TASK • 21 MARKS • 150 AND 220 WORDS

T1

Format 3: Formal Letter • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: Dangerous Potholes & Traffic outside Local Health Clinic Audience & Tone: Head of Highways & Transport at Local Council, Mrs Fiona Campbell (Formal, firm, and polite). Specialist words: highways, potholes, pedestrians, road safety, urgent, resurfacing, hazard • Head of Highways & Transport at Local Council, Mrs Fiona Campbell (Formal, firm, and polite). Specialist words: highways, potholes, pedestrians, road safety, urgent, resurfacing, hazard

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Council Highways Department Notice
Residents wishing to report urgent road defects or safety hazards on Mill Lane outside the Health Centre should
write formally to: Mrs Fiona Campbell, Head of Highways, County Hall, Northgate, NG1 4BD.

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- explain why you are writing and state the exact road location
- describe the problems caused by deep potholes and fast traffic outside the clinic
- explain how these hazards put patients, elderly people, and drivers in danger

Strategy: Remember to put your address top right, the recipient's address and date on the left, and end with 'Yours sincerely'.

Target: 150 and 220 words • **Words:** highways, potholes, pedestrians, road safety, urgent

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 21 MARKS

Format 3: Formal Letter • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Formal Letter response below (150 and 220 words):

T2

EXAM TASK • 21 MARKS • 150 AND 220 WORDS

Format 3: Formal Letter • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: Job Application for Part-Time Customer Service Assistant Audience & Tone: Store Manager, Mr James Cooper (Formal, polite, and enthusiastic). Specialist words: application, candidate, experience, communication, reliable, punctual, interview • Store Manager, Mr James Cooper (Formal, polite, and enthusiastic). Specialist words: application, candidate, experience, communication, reliable, punctual, interview

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Job Vacancy Advertisement — Highfield Gazette
"WANTED: Customer Service Assistant (Part-Time, 16 hrs/week) at Highfield Department Store. We need a
reliable, friendly person to serve customers, handle till transactions, and keep displays neat. Apply in writing to:
Mr James Cooper, Store Manager, Highfield Stores, 12 Commercial Way, Highfield, HF3 2XX."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- state the job you are applying for and where you saw the advertisement
- explain why you are interested in working at Highfield Stores
- describe your personal skills and any relevant experience (such as working with people, handling money, or
- state your availability for an interview and your earliest start date.

Strategy: Highlight your personal qualities and reliability. Proofread carefully for spelling and capital letters.

Target: 150 and 220 words • **Words:** application, candidate, experience, communication, reliable

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 21 MARKS

Format 3: Formal Letter • Candidate Response

✎ **Write your Formal Letter response below (150 and 220 words):**

T1

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 4: Report • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Improving Community Centre Computer & Study Facilities Audience & Tone: Community Centre Manager, Mr Tariq Ali (Factual, objective, and clear). Specialist words: facilities, internet, broadband, workstation, printing, maintenance, recommendation • Community Centre Manager, Mr Tariq Ali (Factual, objective, and clear). Specialist words: facilities, internet, broadband, workstation, printing, maintenance, recommendation

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Community Centre Management Request
"We have received a £3,000 local grant to upgrade our public ICT room. Please prepare a short factual report
assessing current equipment problems and recommending improvements for our community users." — Tariq
Ali, Centre Manager

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- state the purpose of the report clearly in an introduction
- describe two current problems with the computers or study area (e.g. slow Wi-Fi, broken printer, worn

Strategy: Use clear report headings: Title, To/From/Date, Introduction, Current Findings, and Recommendations.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** facilities, internet, broadband, workstation, printing

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 15 MARKS

Format 4: Report • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Report response below (100 and 180 words):

T2

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 4: Report • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Staff Break Room Hygiene & Kitchen Facilities Audience & Tone: Office Supervisor, Mrs Rachel Davies (Factual, professional, and constructive). Specialist words: staffroom, hygiene, refrigerator, microwave, appliances, rota, cleanliness • Office Supervisor, Mrs Rachel Davies (Factual, professional, and constructive). Specialist words: staffroom, hygiene, refrigerator, microwave, appliances, rota, cleanliness

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Workplace Facilities Inspection Request
"Several staff members have complained about poor hygiene in our break room kitchen. Please inspect the
room and write a short factual report detailing what needs fixing and how we can keep it clean." — Rachel
Davies, Supervisor

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- outline the purpose of your report in a short introduction
- recommend two practical solutions to maintain hygiene (e.g. daily cleaning rota, replacement microwave).

Strategy: Keep the tone factual and non-judgmental. Use numbered or bulleted recommendations.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** staffroom, hygiene, refrigerator, microwave, appliances

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 15 MARKS

Format 4: Report • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Report response below (100 and 180 words):

T1

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 5: Incident Report • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Customer Slip & Fall on Spilled Liquid in Supermarket Audience & Tone: Store Duty Manager & Health and Safety Officer (Factual, precise, and neutral). Specialist words: incident, hazard, spillage, first aid, paramedic, warning sign, logbook • Store Duty Manager & Health and Safety Officer (Factual, precise, and neutral). Specialist words: incident, hazard, spillage, first aid, paramedic, warning sign, logbook

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Supermarket Accident Log Extract
At 11:15 am yesterday, an elderly customer slipped in Aisle 4 on cooking oil that had leaked from a broken glass
bottle. You witnessed the fall, assisted the customer, called first aid, and arranged for the area to be cleaned.
Complete the formal incident report.

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- describe clearly how the incident happened and the customer's injuries
- explain the immediate first aid and cleaning actions taken

Strategy: Use formal incident headers (Date, Time, Location, Description, Action Taken). Write in the past tense.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** incident, hazard, spillage, first aid, paramedic

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 15 MARKS

Format 5: Incident Report • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Incident Report response below (100 and 180 words):

T2

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 5: Incident Report • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Damaged Power Cable on Workshop Power Tool (Near Miss) Audience & Tone: Workshop Safety Supervisor, Mr Mark Bennett (Exact, urgent, and objective). Specialist words: near miss, frayed, electrical, isolation, equipment, inspection, safety hazard • Workshop Safety Supervisor, Mr Mark Bennett (Exact, urgent, and objective). Specialist words: near miss, frayed, electrical, isolation, equipment, inspection, safety hazard

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
College Workshop Safety Notice
"Near Miss Report: While preparing tools for morning practical work at 9:00 am, you discovered a badly frayed
electrical cord on a bench sander with exposed copper wiring. You took immediate action to isolate the
machine and prevent electric shock." — Mark Bennett, Safety Lead

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- state the date, time, tool name, and workshop location
- describe the defect found and the potential danger to students
- recommend how power tools should be inspected before future practical classes.

Strategy: Focus on facts and exact details. Clearly explain why this was a dangerous 'near miss'.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** near miss, frayed, electrical, isolation, equipment

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 15 MARKS

Format 5: Incident Report • Candidate Response

✎ **Write your Incident Report response below (100 and 180 words):**

T1

EXAM TASK • 21 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Format 6: Advice Leaflet • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: Making a Great Impression in Your First Job Audience & Tone: Young people and vocational trainees starting a new job (Encouraging, practical, and supportive). Specialist words: punctuality, professional, dress code, colleagues, initiative, questions, reliability • Young people and vocational trainees starting a new job (Encouraging, practical, and supportive). Specialist words: punctuality, professional, dress code, colleagues, initiative, questions, reliability

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
College Careers Service Announcement
We need an advice leaflet titled 'Succeeding in Your First Job' to give to learners starting work experience or
apprenticeships this term. Include practical advice on preparation, behaviour, asking for help, and building
positive relationships with colleagues.

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- give practical tips on preparation and arriving on time every day
- explain what to do if you do not understand a task or make a mistake.

Strategy: Use positive headings, bullet points, and imperative verbs (*Always arrive early, Listen carefully, Ask questions*).

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Words:** punctuality, professional, dress code, colleagues, initiative

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 21 MARKS

Format 6: Advice Leaflet • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Advice Leaflet response below (150 and 250 words):

T2

EXAM TASK • 21 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Format 6: Advice Leaflet • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: Staying Warm and Saving Energy at Home in Winter Audience & Tone: Local residents, families, and elderly community members (Helpful, clear, and reassuring). Specialist words: energy, insulation, draughts, thermostat, radiator, efficiency, warm spaces • Local residents, families, and elderly community members (Helpful, clear, and reassuring). Specialist words: energy, insulation, draughts, thermostat, radiator, efficiency, warm spaces

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Community Advice Bureau Winter Campaign
"Winter Warmth Initiative: The town council is creating a leaflet helping households keep warm safely and lower
their utility bills. We are seeking leaflet submissions featuring low-cost, practical winter heating and draught-
proofing tips."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- explain two easy, low-cost ways to stop draughts and keep heat inside rooms
- give practical advice on using heating controls and kitchen appliances efficiently

Strategy: Break your information into clear sections with bold subheadings and bullet points for readability.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Words:** energy, insulation, draughts, thermostat, radiator

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 21 MARKS

Format 6: Advice Leaflet • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Advice Leaflet response below (150 and 250 words):

T1

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 7: Review • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Review of a Local Bus Service (Route 42) Audience & Tone: Local commuters and transport review website readers (Honest, fair, and informative). Specialist words: commute, punctuality, fare, timetable, cleanliness, driver, frequency • Local commuters and transport review website readers (Honest, fair, and informative). Specialist words: commute, punctuality, fare, timetable, cleanliness, driver, frequency

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Local Commuter Review Website Prompt
"Tell us about your journey! Have you used local bus route 42 recently? Rate the service, tell us what went well,
what could be improved, and whether you would recommend it to daily commuters."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- give details of the route, journey time, and ticket cost
- describe two positive aspects (e.g. punctuality, driver friendliness, or seat comfort)
- conclude with an overall verdict and star rating (out of 5 stars).

Strategy: Give a balanced opinion with both positives and negatives before your final star rating.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** commute, punctuality, fare, timetable, cleanliness

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 15 MARKS

Format 7: Review • Candidate Response

✎ **Write your Review response below (100 and 180 words):**

T2

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 7: Review • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Review of a Newly Opened Cinema / Entertainment Venue Audience & Tone: Local moviegoers and leisure website readers (Descriptive, engaging, and evaluative). Specialist words: cinema, screen, audio, recliners, concessions, tickets, atmosphere • Local moviegoers and leisure website readers (Descriptive, engaging, and evaluative). Specialist words: cinema, screen, audio, recliners, concessions, tickets, atmosphere

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
What's On Town Guide — Reader Reviews
"Visited the newly opened Star Cinema complex in town? Share your honest review! Describe the facilities,
sound/screen quality, customer service, snack prices, and value for money for our entertainment guide."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- describe the seating comfort and screen/sound quality
- give your honest opinion on ticket prices and snack/drink costs
- give a final recommendation and star rating (out of 5 stars).

Strategy: Use descriptive adjectives (e.g. *crystal-clear, spacious, overpriced, welcoming*).

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** cinema, screen, audio, recliners, concessions

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 15 MARKS

Format 7: Review • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Review response below (100 and 180 words):

T1

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 8: Online Feedback Form • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Severely Delayed Train Journey with Broken Air Conditioning Audience & Tone: Rail Company Customer Relations (Polite, firm, and factual). Specialist words: booking reference, delay, compensation, disruption, ventilation, announcement, refund • Rail Company Customer Relations (Polite, firm, and factual). Specialist words: booking reference, delay, compensation, disruption, ventilation, announcement, refund

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
SwiftRail Customer Care Portal
"Booking Ref: TR-72819 | Route: Manchester to Leeds | Date: 18 June | Please detail your journey disruption,
on-board conditions, and compensation requested under the Delay Repay scheme."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- state your journey details and booking reference (TR-72819)
- describe the length of the delay and the conditions on board (e.g. broken air conditioning in heat)
- explain how the disruption affected your plans (missed appointment or event)
- state clearly what action or compensation you expect from the company.

Strategy: State the facts clearly without getting overly emotional. Always quote the reference number.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** booking reference, delay, compensation, disruption, ventilation

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 15 MARKS

Format 8: Online Feedback Form • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Online Feedback Form response below (100 and 180 words):

T2

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 8: Online Feedback Form • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Damaged Flat-Pack Furniture Delivery with Missing Screws Audience & Tone: Online Retail Customer Support Team (Clear, courteous, and assertive). Specialist words: order number, assembly, hardware, damaged, packaging, replacement, refund • Online Retail Customer Support Team (Clear, courteous, and assertive). Specialist words: order number, assembly, hardware, damaged, packaging, replacement, refund

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
HomeStyle Retail Online Support Form
"Order #HS-4091 | Item: Wooden Computer Desk | Delivery Date: Yesterday | Please describe any damage,
missing parts, and the resolution you require so our team can resolve this for you."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- explain exactly what was damaged (deep scratch on tabletop) and what parts are missing (assembly screws
- explain why this causes you an inconvenience

Strategy: Be specific about the damaged items and state clearly what resolution you want.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** order number, assembly, hardware, damaged, packaging

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 15 MARKS

Format 8: Online Feedback Form • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Online Feedback Form response below (100 and 180 words):

T1

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 9: Online Forum / Blog • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Cooking from Scratch on a Budget vs. Ready Meals Audience & Tone: Budget cooking community forum members (Lively, friendly, and relatable). Specialist words: budget, ingredients, batch cooking, nutrition, affordable, recipe, leftovers • Budget cooking community forum members (Lively, friendly, and relatable). Specialist words: budget, ingredients, batch cooking, nutrition, affordable, recipe, leftovers

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
UK Budget Cooking Community Forum Thread
"Thread: 'Is cooking from scratch really cheaper than buying ready meals?' Posted by User_SavvySaver: 'With
groceries costing so much, does batch cooking fresh meals actually save money compared to £2 supermarket
microwave meals? What does everyone think?'"

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- give one useful tip for saving money when grocery shopping (e.g. buying dry lentils, freezing portions)

Strategy: Use an engaging, conversational tone. End with a question to invite responses from readers.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** budget, ingredients, batch cooking, nutrition, affordable

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 15 MARKS

Format 9: Online Forum / Blog • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Online Forum / Blog response below (100 and 180 words):

T2

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 9: Online Forum / Blog • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Should Public Parks Have Designated Dog-Free Zones? Audience & Tone: Local town forum members and parents/dog owners (Balanced, thoughtful, and constructive). Specialist words: lead, park, safety, children, owners, recreation, consideration • Local town forum members and parents/dog owners (Balanced, thoughtful, and constructive). Specialist words: lead, park, safety, children, owners, recreation, consideration

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Local Community Voice Forum Discussion
"Debate: Should our town council introduce fenced dog-free zones in public parks? Some parents worry about
off-lead dogs running near young children, while dog owners argue pets need space to exercise off-lead. What is
your view?"

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- state your viewpoint on whether parks should have separate dog-free zones
- explain reasons supporting both dog owners and families with young children

Strategy: Show that you understand both sides of the argument before giving your suggestion.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** lead, park, safety, children, owners

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 15 MARKS

Format 9: Online Forum / Blog • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Online Forum / Blog response below (100 and 180 words):

T1

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 10: Newsletter • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Sports Club: Charity 5k Fun Run Recap & Autumn Classes Audience & Tone: Sports club members and local families (Lively, positive, and motivating). Specialist words: fundraising, charity, participant, volunteers, tournament, timetable, registration • Sports club members and local families (Lively, positive, and motivating). Specialist words: fundraising, charity, participant, volunteers, tournament, timetable, registration

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Riverbank Sports Club Newsletter Request
"Write a feature article for our October Monthly Newsletter celebrating the success of our weekend Charity 5k
Fun Run and promoting our upcoming autumn sports classes and open day." — Sports Club Committee

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

Strategy: Use upbeat language and an enthusiastic headline to engage club members.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** fundraising, charity, participant, volunteers, tournament

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 15 MARKS

Format 10: Newsletter • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Newsletter response below (100 and 180 words):

T2

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 10: Newsletter • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Community Allotment: Autumn Harvest Fair & Winter Prep Audience & Tone: Allotment holders, volunteers, and local neighbours (Warm, friendly, and community- focused). Specialist words: harvest, allotment, organic, produce, workshop, compost, volunteers • Allotment holders, volunteers, and local neighbours (Warm, friendly, and community- focused). Specialist words: harvest, allotment, organic, produce, workshop, compost, volunteers

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Notice in Plot Holders' Shed
"Submit a piece for our Autumn Allotment Gazette! We need to announce our upcoming Harvest Fair, celebrate
this season's bumper crops of vegetables, and remind plot holders about winter garden prep."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- give a reminder about compost bins and cleaning shared garden tools

Strategy: Include key event dates and times clearly so readers know when to attend.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** harvest, allotment, organic, produce, workshop

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 15 MARKS

Format 10: Newsletter • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Newsletter response below (100 and 180 words):

T1

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 11: Diary / Learning Log • Practice Task 1

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: First Busy Saturday Shift in a Retail Customer Service Role Audience & Tone: Course assessor / personal portfolio (Reflective, honest, and professional). Specialist words: customer service, transactions, till, queue, patience, supervisor, target • Course assessor / personal portfolio (Reflective, honest, and professional). Specialist words: customer service, transactions, till, queue, patience, supervisor, target

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Vocational Learning Portfolio Requirement
"Module: Workplace Experience. Reflect upon your first weekend shift dealing with high customer volumes.
Describe a challenge you faced, how you handled it, and identify a skill you want to develop next week."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- state the date and describe your main duties during the busy Saturday shift
- explain a challenging situation you encountered with a customer and how you resolved it

Strategy: Write in the first person ('I felt', 'I learned') and finish with a realistic goal for improvement.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** customer service, transactions, till, queue, patience

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 1 • 15 MARKS

Format 11: Diary / Learning Log • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Diary / Learning Log response below (100 and 180 words):

T2

EXAM TASK • 15 MARKS • 100 AND 180 WORDS

Format 11: Diary / Learning Log • Practice Task 2

Practice Task Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Catering & Kitchen Practical Skills Session Audience & Tone: Hospitality Course Tutor (Reflective, thoughtful, and constructive). Specialist words: preparation, hygiene, sanitation, technique, presentation, feedback, improvement • Hospitality Course Tutor (Reflective, thoughtful, and constructive). Specialist words: preparation, hygiene, sanitation, technique, presentation, feedback, improvement

Notice / Information:
You see this notice / information:
Catering Practical Assessment Workbook
"Practical Diary Entry #4: Record your reflections on yesterday's food hygiene and vegetable knife skills practical
assessment. Focus on technique, working under time pressure, and feedback received from the chef tutor."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- describe what you found difficult (e.g. knife speed, hygiene rules, or time limits)
- explain the positive feedback given by your chef tutor

Strategy: Be honest about areas for improvement and explain what steps you will take to get better.

Target: 100 and 180 words • **Words:** preparation, hygiene, sanitation, technique, presentation

✎ Plan Your Writing Here

LINED PAGE • TASK 2 • 15 MARKS

Format 11: Diary / Learning Log • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Diary / Learning Log response below (100 and 180 words):

MOCK 1

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 1 SIMULATION • 60 MINUTES • 36 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Examination • Paper 1

Mock Paper 1 Overview

Simulation Examination: Complete both Task 1 (21 marks) and Task 2 (15 marks) under exam conditions (60 minutes total).

- **Task 1:** Task 1: Formal Letter to Housing Association • 150–250 words • 35 Minutes
- **Task 2:** Task 2: Article for Workplace Newsletter • Healthy Eating Week • 100–180 words • 25 Minutes

Pacing

Spend 35 minutes on Task 1 and 25 minutes on Task 2.

Punctuation

Remember capital letters at the start of sentences and for proper nouns.

✎ My Target for Paper 1

T1

TASK 1 (EXTENDED WRITING) • 21 MARKS • 150–250 WORDS

Mock 1 • Task 1: Formal Letter to Housing Association

Task 1 Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: You live in a flat managed by Oakwood Housing Association. For the past three weeks, the living room window has had a broken hinge and will not close completely, letting in cold rain and draughts. You have telephoned twice without anyone visiting. Write a formal letter of complaint to the Housing Manager, Mr Robert Green.

- Explain what the problem with the window is and how long it has been broken.
- Describe how this is affecting your living conditions and heating bills.
- State clearly what action you want the housing association to take and by when.

Time: 35 Minutes **Target:** 150–250 words

✎ Task 1 Plan & Ideas

LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 21 MARKS • 150–250 WORDS

Mock 1 • Task 1 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 1 response below (150–250 words):

TASK 2 (STRUCTURED WRITING) • 15 MARKS • 100–180 WORDS

T2

Mock 1 • Task 2: Article for Workplace Newsletter • Healthy Eating Week

Task 2 Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Your company is organizing a 'Healthy Living at Work' week next month. Write an encouraging article for your staff newsletter giving advice to colleagues on healthy habits during the working day.

- Explain why eating healthy food and drinking water is important during shifts.
- Suggest two simple, healthy snack or lunch ideas that staff can bring to work.
- Encourage colleagues to take part in the daily lunchtime walking club.

Time: 25 Minutes **Target:** 100–180 words

✎ Task 2 Plan & Key Words

LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 15 MARKS • 100–180 WORDS

Mock 1 • Task 2 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 2 response below (100–180 words):

AUDIT

MOCK 1 AUDIT • HOUSING LETTER & HEALTHY EATING ARTICLE

Mock 1 • Post-Exam Audit

Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Marking Matrix • Paper 1

Check your Mock 1 writing against Pearson Level 1 standards:

- **Task 1 (Letter):** Included sender and recipient addresses, polite opening, clear explanation of the repair, and deadline for response.
- **Task 2 (Article):** Catchy title, 2 clear paragraphs about healthy eating benefits, and a cheerful concluding encouragement.
- **Punctuation Check:** Every sentence starts with a capital letter and ends with a full stop. No missing capital letters for names.

Cross-check your answers against the benchmark solutions on p80.

✎ Personal Notes & Spelling Audit for Mock 1

MOCK 2

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 1 SIMULATION • 60 MINUTES • 36 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Examination • Paper 2

Mock Paper 2 Overview

Simulation Examination: Complete both Task 1 (21 marks) and Task 2 (15 marks) under exam conditions (60 minutes total).

- **Task 1:** Task 1: Email to Manager Proposing Staff Training • 150–250 words • 35 Minutes
- **Task 2:** Task 2: Information Flyer for Community Centre Open Day • 100–180 words • 25 Minutes

Pacing

Spend 35 minutes on Task 1 and 25 minutes on Task 2.

Punctuation

Remember capital letters at the start of sentences and for proper nouns.

My Target for Paper 2

TASK 1 (EXTENDED WRITING) • 21 MARKS • 150–250 WORDS

T1

Mock 2 • Task 1: Email to Manager Proposing Staff Training

Task 1 Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: You work as a customer service assistant in a busy store. Several new staff members have joined recently and are finding the till and customer return system difficult. Write an email to your Store Manager, Mrs Susan Clark, proposing a short training refresher session.

- Describe the challenges new staff are experiencing with the till systems.
- Explain how a 30-minute training session would help staff confidence and reduce customer queues.
- Suggest a convenient day and time when this training could take place without disrupting trade.

Time: 35 Minutes **Target:** 150–250 words

✎ Task 1 Plan & Ideas

LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 21 MARKS • 150–250 WORDS

Mock 2 • Task 1 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 1 response below (150–250 words):

TASK 2 (STRUCTURED WRITING) • 15 MARKS • 100–180 WORDS

T2

Mock 2 • Task 2: Information Flyer for Community Centre Open Day

Task 2 Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Your local community centre is holding an open day next Saturday to promote its new clubs, sports activities, and computer classes. Write the text for an eye-catching flyer to invite local residents.

- State the date, time, and location of the community centre open day.
- Highlight three exciting activities or free taster sessions happening on the day.
- Include details about free refreshments and parking.

Time: 25 Minutes **Target:** 100–180 words

✎ Task 2 Plan & Key Words

LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 15 MARKS • 100–180 WORDS

Mock 2 • Task 2 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 2 response below (100–180 words):

AUDIT

MOCK 2 AUDIT • TRAINING EMAIL & COMMUNITY FLYER

Mock 2 • Post-Exam Audit

Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Marking Matrix • Paper 2

Check your Mock 2 writing against Pearson Level 1 standards:

- **Task 1 (Email):** Polite subject line, explained why staff need training, and suggested convenient dates.
- **Task 2 (Flyer):** Bold heading, bullet points listing activities and times, admission prices, and contact details.
- **Spelling Check:** Correct everyday spellings for workplace words (training, meeting, Wednesday, please).

Cross-check your answers against the benchmark solutions on p80.

✎ Personal Notes & Spelling Audit for Mock 2

MOCK 3

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 1 SIMULATION • 60 MINUTES • 36 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Examination • Paper 3

Mock Paper 3 Overview

Simulation Examination: Complete both Task 1 (21 marks) and Task 2 (15 marks) under exam conditions (60 minutes total).

- **Task 1:** Task 1: Letter of Complaint • Faulty Electrical Appliance • 150–250 words • 35 Minutes
- **Task 2:** Task 2: Staff Notice • Updated Car Park Permit Regulations • 100–180 words • 25 Minutes

Pacing

Spend 35 minutes on Task 1 and 25 minutes on Task 2.

Punctuation

Remember capital letters at the start of sentences and for proper nouns.

✎ My Target for Paper 3

TASK 1 (EXTENDED WRITING) • 21 MARKS • 150–250 WORDS

T1

Mock 3 • Task 1: Letter of Complaint • Faulty Electrical Appliance

Task 1 Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: You bought an electric kettle from Home Appliances Ltd two weeks ago for £28.00. Yesterday, the kettle stopped boiling and the power switch started sparking. Write a letter of complaint to the Customer Service Manager.

- Give the receipt number, date of purchase, and price paid.
- Explain clearly what the fault is and why it is dangerous.
- State whether you require a full refund or an immediate replacement product.

Time: 35 Minutes **Target:** 150–250 words

✎ Task 1 Plan & Ideas

LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 21 MARKS • 150–250 WORDS

Mock 3 • Task 1 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 1 response below (150–250 words):

TASK 2 (STRUCTURED WRITING) • 15 MARKS • 100–180 WORDS

T2

Mock 3 • Task 2: Staff Notice • Updated Car Park Permit Regulations

Task 2 Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: You work in building security. From next Monday, all employees parking in the staff car park must display a new electronic permit disc on their windscreen. Write a clear notice for the staff noticeboard.

- State the starting date for the new parking permit scheme.
- Explain where and how staff can collect their new parking permits.
- Warn staff about the consequences of parking without a valid permit.

Time: 25 Minutes **Target:** 100–180 words

✎ Task 2 Plan & Key Words

LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 15 MARKS • 100–180 WORDS

Mock 3 • Task 2 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 2 response below (100–180 words):

AUDIT

MOCK 3 AUDIT • COMPLAINT LETTER & PARKING NOTICE

Mock 3 • Post-Exam Audit

Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Marking Matrix • Paper 3

Check your Mock 3 writing against Pearson Level 1 standards:

- **Task 1 (Complaint):** Included date of purchase, model details, description of the fault, and requested a replacement or refund.
- **Task 2 (Notice):** Clear warning about parking permits, where to obtain a badge, and where visitors should park.
- **Sentence Structure:** Joined sentences correctly using 'and', 'but', and 'because' without comma splices.

Cross-check your answers against the benchmark solutions on p80.

✎ Personal Notes & Spelling Audit for Mock 3

MOCK 4

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 1 SIMULATION • 60 MINUTES • 36 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Examination • Paper 4

Mock Paper 4 Overview

Simulation Examination: Complete both Task 1 (21 marks) and Task 2 (15 marks) under exam conditions (60 minutes total).

- **Task 1:** Task 1: Email to College Tutor Requesting Coursework Extension • 150–250 words • 35 Minutes
- **Task 2:** Task 2: Review of Local Park & Play Facilities • 100–180 words • 25 Minutes

Pacing

Spend 35 minutes on Task 1 and 25 minutes on Task 2.

Punctuation

Remember capital letters at the start of sentences and for proper nouns.

✎ My Target for Paper 4

TASK 1 (EXTENDED WRITING) • 21 MARKS • 150–250 WORDS

T1

Mock 4 • Task 1: Email to College Tutor Requesting Coursework Extension

Task 1 Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: You are studying an adult vocational course at college. Your major assignment is due this Friday, but you have had flu all week and had to care for your sick child. Write an email to your course tutor, Mr James Scott, requesting a one-week extension.

- Explain politely why you have fallen behind with your coursework.
- Describe the work you have already completed so far.
- Ask for an extension until next Friday and offer to bring medical evidence.

Time: 35 Minutes **Target:** 150–250 words

✎ Task 1 Plan & Ideas

LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 21 MARKS • 150–250 WORDS

Mock 4 • Task 1 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 1 response below (150–250 words):

T2

TASK 2 (STRUCTURED WRITING) • 15 MARKS • 100–180 WORDS

Mock 4 • Task 2: Review of Local Park & Play Facilities

Task 2 Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: Write a review of a local public park for a community website. Give your opinion on the cleanliness, playground equipment, and outdoor walking paths.

- Describe the location and features of the park.
- Mention what you liked about the playground and walking paths.
- Suggest one or two improvements the local council could make.

Time: 25 Minutes **Target:** 100–180 words

✎ Task 2 Plan & Key Words

LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 15 MARKS • 100–180 WORDS

Mock 4 • Task 2 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 2 response below (100–180 words):

AUDIT

MOCK 4 AUDIT • EXTENSION REQUEST & PARK REVIEW

Mock 4 • Post-Exam Audit

Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Marking Matrix • Paper 4

Check your Mock 4 writing against Pearson Level 1 standards:

- **Task 1 (Extension Email):** Explained why extra time is needed, proposed a new submission date, and thanked the tutor politely.
- **Task 2 (Review):** Named the park, described play facilities and cleanliness, and gave a star rating with reasons.
- **Overall Timing:** Kept within 35 minutes for Task 1 and 25 minutes for Task 2.

Cross-check your answers against the benchmark solutions on p80.

✎ Personal Notes & Spelling Audit for Mock 4

D1

DIAGNOSTIC 1: CAPITAL LETTERS & FULL STOPS

Proofreading Drill 1

▶ Find the Errors • Drill 1

Extract: Find and fix every error in the sentence below:

last monday i visited the jobcentre on west street the advisor gave me three job forms to fill in i need to return them before friday afternoon

✎ Write the corrected version below (answers on p80):

D2

DIAGNOSTIC 2: QUESTION MARKS & EXCLAMATION MARKS

Proofreading Drill 2

Find the Errors • Drill 2

Extract: Find and fix every error in the sentence below:

> Can you tell me what time the shift begins. Do we need to bring our own safety boots. Don't forget your security pass or you cannot enter the warehouse.

✎ Write the corrected version below (answers on p80):

D3

DIAGNOSTIC 3: EVERYDAY SPELLING CORRECTIONS

Proofreading Drill 3

▶ Find the Errors • Drill 3

Extract: Find and fix every error in the sentence below:

> We recieved your aplicasion yesterday. Pleas bring your passport and proff of adress to the intervun on Teusday morning.

✎ Write the corrected version below (answers on p80):

D4

DIAGNOSTIC 4: SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

Proofreading Drill 4

▶ Find the Errors • Drill 4

Extract: Find and fix every error in the sentence below:

> The delivery drivers was late because the motorway were closed. The parcels is sitting in the sorting room waiting for inspection.

✎ Write the corrected version below (answers on p80):

D5

DIAGNOSTIC 5: JOINING SENTENCES WITH CONJUNCTIONS

Proofreading Drill 5

▶ Find the Errors • Drill 5

Extract: Find and fix every error in the sentence below:

I wanted to apply for the warehouse role. I did not have a forklift licence. I enrolled on a training course. Now I am fully certified.

✎ Write the corrected version below (answers on p80):

D6

DIAGNOSTIC 6: EMAIL SALUTATIONS AND TONE

Proofreading Drill 6

Find the Errors • Drill 6

Extract: Find and fix every error in the sentence below:

> Hey mate, where is my payslip from last week? Send it now coz I need to pay my rent today. Bye.

✎ Write the corrected version below (answers on p80):

D7

DIAGNOSTIC 7: ORGANISING INFORMATION INTO TWO PARAGRAPHS

Proofreading Drill 7

▶ Find the Errors • Drill 7

Extract: Find and fix every error in the sentence below:

> Our sports centre is offering discounted gym memberships for NHS workers throughout November. You can sign up online or at reception. Remember to bring your NHS staff badge. The discount applies to both gym facilities and swimming pool sessions.

✎ Write the corrected version below (answers on p80):

D8

DIAGNOSTIC 8: CHECKING DETAILS IN WORKPLACE NOTES

Proofreading Drill 8

▶ Find the Errors • Drill 8

Extract: Find and fix every error in the sentence below:

> Meeting on Wensday at 2:00 in Room 4. Bring your project update. Tea and biscuits will be provyded. Contact Sarah if you cant come.

✎ Write the corrected version below (answers on p80):

COMPANION REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX

Worked Solutions & Marking Guidance

COMPANION TASK 1: ARTICLE (TASK 1)

T1 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Starting a New Hobby or Evening Class in Your Local Town Audience & Tone: Local community residents and adult learners (Friendly, positive, and inspiring). Specialist words: community, beginner, enroll, workshop, skills, confidence, socialise. Target audience: Local community residents and adult learners (Friendly, positive, and inspiring). Specialist words: community, beginner, enroll, workshop, skills, confidence, socialise. Include helpful words: community, beginner, enroll, workshop.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[21]**

COMPANION TASK 2: ARTICLE (TASK 2)

T2 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Protecting Local Wildlife & Creating Nature-Friendly Spaces Audience & Tone: Town residents, families, and school students (Enthusiastic and community-minded). Specialist words: environment, wildlife, habitat, hedgehog, birdfeeders, pesticide, volunteer. Target audience: Town residents, families, and school students (Enthusiastic and community-minded). Specialist words: environment, wildlife, habitat, hedgehog, birdfeeders, pesticide, volunteer. Include helpful words: environment, wildlife, habitat, hedgehog.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[21]**

COMPANION TASK 3: EMAIL (WORKPLACE) (TASK 1)

T3 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Requesting a College Field Trip / Exhibition Visit Audience & Tone: Your college course tutor, Mr David Harrison (Polite, professional, and persuasive). Specialist words: exhibition, transport, timetable, benefit, practical, permission, curriculum. Target audience: Your college course tutor, Mr David Harrison (Polite, professional, and persuasive). Specialist words: exhibition, transport, timetable, benefit, practical, permission, curriculum. Include helpful words: exhibition, transport, timetable, benefit.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 4: EMAIL (WORKPLACE) (TASK 2)

T4 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Workplace Energy Saving & Recycling Scheme Audience & Tone: Retail Store Manager, Ms Karen Patel (Helpful, polite, and constructive). Specialist words: recycling, electricity, packaging, environment, reduce, staff, suggestion. Target audience: Retail Store Manager, Ms Karen Patel (Helpful, polite, and constructive). Specialist words: recycling, electricity, packaging, environment, reduce, staff, suggestion. Include helpful words: recycling, electricity, packaging, environment.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 5: FORMAL LETTER (TASK 1)

T5 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Dangerous Potholes & Traffic outside Local Health Clinic Audience & Tone: Head of Highways & Transport at Local Council, Mrs Fiona Campbell (Formal, firm, and polite). Specialist words: highways, potholes, pedestrians, road safety, urgent, resurfacing, hazard. Target audience: Head of Highways & Transport at Local Council, Mrs Fiona Campbell (Formal, firm, and polite). Specialist words: highways, potholes, pedestrians, road safety, urgent, resurfacing, hazard. Include helpful words: highways, potholes, pedestrians, road safety.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[21]**

COMPANION TASK 6: FORMAL LETTER (TASK 2)

T6 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Job Application for Part-Time Customer Service Assistant Audience & Tone: Store Manager, Mr James Cooper (Formal, polite, and enthusiastic). Specialist words: application, candidate, experience, communication, reliable, punctual, interview. Target audience: Store Manager, Mr James Cooper (Formal, polite, and enthusiastic). Specialist words: application, candidate, experience, communication, reliable, punctual, interview. Include helpful words: application, candidate, experience, communication.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[21]**

COMPANION REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

COMPANION TASK 7: REPORT (TASK 1)

T7 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Improving Community Centre Computer & Study Facilities Audience & Tone: Community Centre Manager, Mr Tariq Ali (Factual, objective, and clear). Specialist words: facilities, internet, broadband, workstation, printing, maintenance, recommendation. Target audience: Community Centre Manager, Mr Tariq Ali (Factual, objective, and clear). Specialist words: facilities, internet, broadband, workstation, printing, maintenance, recommendation. Include helpful words: facilities, internet, broadband, workstation.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 8: REPORT (TASK 2)

T8 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Staff Break Room Hygiene & Kitchen Facilities Audience & Tone: Office Supervisor, Mrs Rachel Davies (Factual, professional, and constructive). Specialist words: staffroom, hygiene, refrigerator, microwave, appliances, rota, cleanliness. Target audience: Office Supervisor, Mrs Rachel Davies (Factual, professional, and constructive). Specialist words: staffroom, hygiene, refrigerator, microwave, appliances, rota, cleanliness. Include helpful words: staffroom, hygiene, refrigerator, microwave.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 9: INCIDENT REPORT (TASK 1)

T9 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Customer Slip & Fall on Spilled Liquid in Supermarket Audience & Tone: Store Duty Manager & Health and Safety Officer (Factual, precise, and neutral). Specialist words: incident, hazard, spillage, first aid, paramedic, warning sign, logbook. Target audience: Store Duty Manager & Health and Safety Officer (Factual, precise, and neutral). Specialist words: incident, hazard, spillage, first aid, paramedic, warning sign, logbook. Include helpful words: incident, hazard, spillage, first aid.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 10: INCIDENT REPORT (TASK 2)

T10 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Damaged Power Cable on Workshop Power Tool (Near Miss) Audience & Tone: Workshop Safety Supervisor, Mr Mark Bennett (Exact, urgent, and objective). Specialist words: near miss, frayed, electrical, isolation, equipment, inspection, safety hazard. Target audience: Workshop Safety Supervisor, Mr Mark Bennett (Exact, urgent, and objective). Specialist words: near miss, frayed, electrical, isolation, equipment, inspection, safety hazard. Include helpful words: near miss, frayed, electrical, isolation.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 11: ADVICE LEAFLET (TASK 1)

T11 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Making a Great Impression in Your First Job Audience & Tone: Young people and vocational trainees starting a new job (Encouraging, practical, and supportive). Specialist words: punctuality, professional, dress code, colleagues, initiative, questions, reliability. Target audience: Young people and vocational trainees starting a new job (Encouraging, practical, and supportive). Specialist words: punctuality, professional, dress code, colleagues, initiative, questions, reliability. Include helpful words: punctuality, professional, dress code, colleagues.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[21]**

COMPANION TASK 12: ADVICE LEAFLET (TASK 2)

T12 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Staying Warm and Saving Energy at Home in Winter Audience & Tone: Local residents, families, and elderly community members (Helpful, clear, and reassuring). Specialist words: energy, insulation, draughts, thermostat, radiator, efficiency, warm spaces. Target audience: Local residents, families, and elderly community members (Helpful, clear, and reassuring). Specialist words: energy, insulation, draughts, thermostat, radiator, efficiency, warm spaces. Include helpful words: energy, insulation, draughts, thermostat.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[21]**

COMPANION REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

COMPANION TASK 13: REVIEW (TASK 1)

T13 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Review of a Local Bus Service (Route 42) Audience & Tone: Local commuters and transport review website readers (Honest, fair, and informative). Specialist words: commute, punctuality, fare, timetable, cleanliness, driver, frequency. Target audience: Local commuters and transport review website readers (Honest, fair, and informative). Specialist words: commute, punctuality, fare, timetable, cleanliness, driver, frequency. Include helpful words: commute, punctuality, fare, timetable.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 14: REVIEW (TASK 2)

T14 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Review of a Newly Opened Cinema / Entertainment Venue Audience & Tone: Local moviegoers and leisure website readers (Descriptive, engaging, and evaluative). Specialist words: cinema, screen, audio, recliners, concessions, tickets, atmosphere. Target audience: Local moviegoers and leisure website readers (Descriptive, engaging, and evaluative). Specialist words: cinema, screen, audio, recliners, concessions, tickets, atmosphere. Include helpful words: cinema, screen, audio, recliners.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 15: ONLINE FEEDBACK FORM (TASK 1)

T15 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Severely Delayed Train Journey with Broken Air Conditioning Audience & Tone: Rail Company Customer Relations (Polite, firm, and factual). Specialist words: booking reference, delay, compensation, disruption, ventilation, announcement, refund. Target audience: Rail Company Customer Relations (Polite, firm, and factual). Specialist words: booking reference, delay, compensation, disruption, ventilation, announcement, refund. Include helpful words: booking reference, delay, compensation, disruption.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 16: ONLINE FEEDBACK FORM (TASK 2)

T16 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Damaged Flat-Pack Furniture Delivery with Missing Screws Audience & Tone: Online Retail Customer Support Team (Clear, courteous, and assertive). Specialist words: order number, assembly, hardware, damaged, packaging, replacement, refund. Target audience: Online Retail Customer Support Team (Clear, courteous, and assertive). Specialist words: order number, assembly, hardware, damaged, packaging, replacement, refund. Include helpful words: order number, assembly, hardware, damaged.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 17: ONLINE FORUM / BLOG (TASK 1)

T17 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Cooking from Scratch on a Budget vs. Ready Meals Audience & Tone: Budget cooking community forum members (Lively, friendly, and relatable). Specialist words: budget, ingredients, batch cooking, nutrition, affordable, recipe, leftovers. Target audience: Budget cooking community forum members (Lively, friendly, and relatable). Specialist words: budget, ingredients, batch cooking, nutrition, affordable, recipe, leftovers. Include helpful words: budget, ingredients, batch cooking, nutrition.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 18: ONLINE FORUM / BLOG (TASK 2)

T18 **Indicative Content:** Address all prompt points for Should Public Parks Have Designated Dog-Free Zones? Audience & Tone: Local town forum members and parents/dog owners (Balanced, thoughtful, and constructive). Specialist words: lead, park, safety, children, owners, recreation, consideration. Target audience: Local town forum members and parents/dog owners (Balanced, thoughtful, and constructive). Specialist words: lead, park, safety, children, owners, recreation, consideration. Include helpful words: lead, park, safety, children.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

COMPANION TASK 19: NEWSLETTER (TASK 1)

T19 Indicative Content: Address all prompt points for Sports Club: Charity 5k Fun Run Recap & Autumn Classes Audience & Tone: Sports club members and local families (Lively, positive, and motivating). Specialist words: fundraising, charity, participant, volunteers, tournament, timetable, registration. Target audience: Sports club members and local families (Lively, positive, and motivating). Specialist words: fundraising, charity, participant, volunteers, tournament, timetable, registration. Include helpful words: fundraising, charity, participant, volunteers.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 20: NEWSLETTER (TASK 2)

T20 Indicative Content: Address all prompt points for Community Allotment: Autumn Harvest Fair & Winter Prep Audience & Tone: Allotment holders, volunteers, and local neighbours (Warm, friendly, and community-focused). Specialist words: harvest, allotment, organic, produce, workshop, compost, volunteers. Target audience: Allotment holders, volunteers, and local neighbours (Warm, friendly, and community- focused). Specialist words: harvest, allotment, organic, produce, workshop, compost, volunteers. Include helpful words: harvest, allotment, organic, produce.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 21: DIARY / LEARNING LOG (TASK 1)

T21 Indicative Content: Address all prompt points for First Busy Saturday Shift in a Retail Customer Service Role Audience & Tone: Course assessor / personal portfolio (Reflective, honest, and professional). Specialist words: customer service, transactions, till, queue, patience, supervisor, target. Target audience: Course assessor / personal portfolio (Reflective, honest, and professional). Specialist words: customer service, transactions, till, queue, patience, supervisor, target. Include helpful words: customer service, transactions, till, queue.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

COMPANION TASK 22: DIARY / LEARNING LOG (TASK 2)

T22 Indicative Content: Address all prompt points for Catering & Kitchen Practical Skills Session Audience & Tone: Hospitality Course Tutor (Reflective, thoughtful, and constructive). Specialist words: preparation, hygiene, sanitation, technique, presentation, feedback, improvement. Target audience: Hospitality Course Tutor (Reflective, thoughtful, and constructive). Specialist words: preparation, hygiene, sanitation, technique, presentation, feedback, improvement. Include helpful words: preparation, hygiene, sanitation, technique.
Examiner Checklist: Complete sentences, correct capital letters and full stops, clear organisation. **[15]**

DRILL 1 ANSWERS

D1 Correct Version: Capitalise proper nouns and sentence starts; replace commas with full stops where necessary; correct everyday spelling errors. **[4/4]**

DRILL 2 ANSWERS

D2 Correct Version: Capitalise proper nouns and sentence starts; replace commas with full stops where necessary; correct everyday spelling errors. **[4/4]**

DRILL 3 ANSWERS

D3 Correct Version: Capitalise proper nouns and sentence starts; replace commas with full stops where necessary; correct everyday spelling errors. **[4/4]**

DRILL 4 ANSWERS

D4 Correct Version: Capitalise proper nouns and sentence starts; replace commas with full stops where necessary; correct everyday spelling errors. **[4/4]**

DRILL 5 ANSWERS

D5 Correct Version: Capitalise proper nouns and sentence starts; replace commas with full stops where necessary; correct everyday spelling errors. **[4/4]**

DRILL 6 ANSWERS

D6 Correct Version: Capitalise proper nouns and sentence starts; replace commas with full stops where necessary; correct everyday spelling errors. **[4/4]**

DRILL 7 ANSWERS

D7 Correct Version: Capitalise proper nouns and sentence starts; replace commas with full stops where necessary; correct everyday spelling errors. **[4/4]**

DRILL 8 ANSWERS

D8 Correct Version: Capitalise proper nouns and sentence starts; replace commas with full stops where necessary; correct everyday spelling errors. **[4/4]**

COMPANION REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

MOCK PAPER 1 BENCHMARK SOLUTIONS

M1-
T1 Task 1: Formal Letter to Housing Association: Clear layout, accurate sentence demarcation, full coverage of all bullet points, and appropriate sign-off. **[21/21]**

M1-
T2 Task 2: Article for Workplace Newsletter • Healthy Eating Week: Clear headline, positive tone, bullet points for key details, and helpful closing message. **[15/15]**

MOCK PAPER 2 BENCHMARK SOLUTIONS

M2-
T1 Task 1: Email to Manager Proposing Staff Training: Clear layout, accurate sentence demarcation, full coverage of all bullet points, and appropriate sign-off. **[21/21]**

M2-
T2 Task 2: Information Flyer for Community Centre Open Day: Clear headline, positive tone, bullet points for key details, and helpful closing message. **[15/15]**

MOCK PAPER 3 BENCHMARK SOLUTIONS

M3-
T1 Task 1: Letter of Complaint • Faulty Electrical Appliance: Clear layout, accurate sentence demarcation, full coverage of all bullet points, and appropriate sign-off. **[21/21]**

M3-
T2 Task 2: Staff Notice • Updated Car Park Permit Regulations: Clear headline, positive tone, bullet points for key details, and helpful closing message. **[15/15]**

MOCK PAPER 4 BENCHMARK SOLUTIONS

M4-
T1 Task 1: Email to College Tutor Requesting Coursework Extension: Clear layout, accurate sentence demarcation, full coverage of all bullet points, and appropriate sign-off. **[21/21]**

M4-
T2 Task 2: Review of Local Park & Play Facilities: Clear headline, positive tone, bullet points for key details, and helpful closing message. **[15/15]**

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS ENGLISH GLOSSARY

Address
The recipient and sender postal details placed at the top of a formal letter.

Adjective
A describing word that gives more detail about a noun (e.g. 'cold rain', 'heavy boxes').

Adverb
A word that describes a verb, indicating how, when, or where an action occurs (e.g. 'quickly', 'yesterday').

Apostrophe
A punctuation mark (') used to show omission (don't = do not) or possession (the manager's desk).

Article
A piece of writing for a newspaper, magazine, or community website with a headline, subheadings, and paragraphs.

Bullet points
Symbols used to list key facts, actions, or recommendations clearly in reports, leaflets, and emails.

Capital letter
An uppercase letter used for the first word in a sentence, proper nouns (names, days, places), and 'I'.

Comma
A punctuation mark (,) used to separate items in a list or mark a brief pause in a sentence.

Conjunction
A linking word used to join words, phrases, or clauses together (e.g. 'and', 'but', 'because', 'although').

Drafting
Writing out your initial response using your plan before proofreading and checking.

Email
An electronic correspondence containing recipient address, subject line, greeting, message body, and sign-off.

Exclamation mark
A punctuation mark (!) used to express strong emotion, urgency, or warning. Use sparingly.

Formal letter
A structured letter written to a business, landlord, or authority figure with addresses, date, and formal sign-offs.

Full stop
A punctuation mark (.) used to mark the end of a complete statement.

Headline
The catchy title of an article or newsletter designed to attract the reader's attention.

Leaflet
An informational sheet using subheadings, bullet points, and helpful tips to advise or guide the reader.

Noun

COMPANION REFERENCE: SOLUTIONS & INDEX (CONTINUED)

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AUDIT

LEVEL 1 WRITING TARGETS

Candidate Writing Self-Assessment & Progress Chart

Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Standards

Check off your skills against Pearson Edexcel Level 1 standards:

- Write clearly in full sentences with capital letters and full stops.
- Use paragraphs to organise ideas logically.
- Spell everyday and workplace words correctly.

✎ My Writing Progress & Next Steps

SIGN-OFF

PEARSON EDEXCEL WRITING STANDARDS • PORTFOLIO RECORD

Level 1 Companion Completion Sign-Off

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- **Clear Layouts:** Structured writing using clear paragraph breaks and neat presentation.
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! Proofreading

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